ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** hope and open choice	Opportunity.
2	**(b)** it can overcome physical limits	Result.
3	**(c)** should	Duty.
4	**(c)** inspire readers through lived experience	Purpose.
5	**(b)** earnest and encouraging	Positive.
6	**(b)** Many barriers have been broken by athletes.	Have been broken.
7	**(c)** they display strength and skill publicly	Visibility.
8	**(b)** values one another over the prize	They care for each other.
9	**(b)** She asked if I was ready.	Question to statement.
10	**(b)** wants focus on strengths	Positive framing.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She believes ability is about mind and effort (1) so she focuses on what she can do (1).	1+1
12	By providing equal access (1) and changing attitudes (1).	1+1
13	It confirms the value of the act (1) and shows society's approval of kindness (1).	1+1
14	It gives purpose and community (1) and proves their strengths to society (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	By stressing her achievements (1). By letting her speak of struggles (1). By ending with advice (1).	1+1+1
16	Questions invite reflection (1). Direct answers make readers feel addressed (1). It adds a personal touch (1).	1+1+1
17	Dr Malik is an athlete who won a silver medal (1). 'Who' joins the sentences (1). It makes a relative clause (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She says mind matters more than body (1). Mental strength helped training (1). It helped overcome social hurdles (1).	1+1+1
18	The race begins (1). The fall creates tension (1). The return of the runners is the climax (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She is not only brave but also kind (1). Correlative conjunctions pair ideas (1). Stress is on both qualities (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Her illness (1). Her choice to focus on possibility (1). Success in sport (1). Strengths from struggle (1). Inspiration to others (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The title promises a contest (1). 'Nine gold' broadens meaning (1). Ending shows shared joy (1). Irony of winning by losing (1). Message stays (1).	2+2+1
20	Society's view limits (1). Dr Malik's own view empowers (1). Sport reshapes both (1). Inclusion benefits all (1). Call to change (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Story (1). Language and imagery (1). Mood (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Treating the first piece as a story. 'The World of Limitless Possibilities' is an **interview** with Dr Deepa Malik, so answers should say 'she says' and use question-and-answer content.
- Mixing up the medal: Dr Malik won a **silver** medal in shot put at the Rio Paralympics (2016). Do not call it an Olympic gold; the Paralympics are for athletes with disabilities.
- Explaining 'ability beyond disability' as 'disabled people cannot work'. It means talent and strength go beyond physical limits, and sport changes how society sees persons with disabilities.
- Stating that the main hurdle was only the body. She points to society's attitude and underestimation; the answer must include resilience, treating setbacks as chances to grow.

- In 'Nine Gold Medals', saying one runner wins. The nine runners finish together, so **compassion matters more than winning**, which explains the title.
- Spelling and article slips: *Paralympic* (not 'Paraolympic'), *an* athlete, plural *medals*; do not mix up 'success' and 'failure' when asked for an opposite.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a turning point	Triggers action.
2	**(a)** yet	Contrast.
3	**(d)** a difficulty that delays progress	A hindrance.
4	**(b)** values placed above winning	Priorities.
5	**(a)** Neither of the runners was late.	Neither + singular.
6	**(b)** returning to training after failure	Bounce back.
7	**(c)** imagery of sound and sight	Sensory image.
8	**(c)** fair and generous approach to play	Idiom-like phrase.
9	**(c)** extend the message to the reader	Guidance.
10	**(c)** return to help	A tender moment.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It sets up a choice (1) between winning and caring (1).	1+1
12	It shows athletes with disabilities as models of compassion (1) and challenges stereotypes (1).	1+1
13	It allows her own voice to tell the story (1) and the questions bring out lessons (1).	1+1
14	Gold stands for worth and honour (1). Each earned it through compassion (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Attitudes limit chances (1). Stereotypes discourage (1). Change in attitude helps inclusion (1).	1+1+1
16	Linked arms at the finish (1). It sums up unity (1). It leaves a lasting picture (1).	1+1+1
17	It means to do more than required (1). The runners returned to help (1). It shows extra kindness (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sport teaches discipline (1). It teaches teamwork (1). It teaches coping with failure (1).	1+1+1
18	It sounds natural (1). It suits the child-like innocence of the scene (1). It keeps focus on the act (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dr Malik: courage to rebuild life (1). Runners: courage to stop and help (1). Both cost something (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Positive words (1). Short and direct sentences (1). Personal stories (1). Advice to others (1). Hopeful ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). The poem's example (1). Benefits of cooperation (1). Real life examples (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Her setback (1). Her response (1). Her success (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Place and time (1). Events (1). Reaction (1). Concluding line (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Stating that the main hurdle was only the body. She points to society's attitude and underestimation; the answer must include resilience, treating setbacks as chances to grow.
- In 'Nine Gold Medals', saying one runner wins. The nine runners finish together, so **compassion matters more than winning**, which explains the title.
- Spelling and article slips: *Paralympic* (not 'Paraolympic'), *an* athlete, plural *medals*; do not mix up 'success' and 'failure' when asked for an opposite.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** opposite meaning	In/ex.
2	**(c)** authenticity	Direct voice.
3	**(b)** metaphor	Hearts are gold.
4	**(c)** Dr Malik won a silver medal at Rio.	Fact vs opinion.
5	**(a)** fixed ideas about disability	Preconceived notions.
6	**(a)** not only material	Moral reward.
7	**(b)** Kindness is worth more than a medal.	A view.
8	**(c)** inclusiveness	Inclusion.
9	**(b)** narrative poem	It tells a story.
10	**(d)** Nine Runners, One Finish	Relevant.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Both show that limits do not define people (1). The runners and the athlete reach beyond limits (1).	1+1
12	Seeing a difficulty as a chance to learn (1) and to prove strength (1).	1+1
13	Kindness is stronger than speed (1) because the runners put care above the race (1).	1+1
14	They teach teamwork and respect (1) and show how to treat classmates with differing abilities (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Family gives emotional strength (1). Coaches give skill (1). Society gives opportunities (1).	1+1+1
16	Competition is replaced by cooperation (1). Winning together is celebrated (1). Kindness matters more than rank (1).	1+1+1
17	The crowd gives approval (1). Its cheers reinforce values (1). Society shapes how we see winners (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It ends with advice (1). It shows a model (1). It calls for an inclusive society (1).	1+1+1
18	Dr Malik said that she was proud of her team (1). Present becomes past (1). 'I' becomes 'she' and 'my' becomes 'her' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She would admire the kindness (1). It fits her view of inclusion (1). She would see the runners as equals (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Equal chances (1). Role models (1). Shared goals (1). Breaking stereotypes (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Interview: personal triumph (1). Poem: group triumph (1). Both stress values (1). Both redefine success (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	A simple story (1). A turning point (1). Action not speech (1). Image of unity (1). Moral implied (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). The fall recalled (1). Why they turned back (1). Their feelings (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

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- In 'Nine Gold Medals', saying one runner wins. The nine runners finish together, so **compassion matters more than winning**, which explains the title.

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